Gorakhpur who unabashedly criticized his MLA, and from the powerful Adivasi woman who was the victim of a heinous crime to the Delhi professor who took a state government to court for establishing an armed civilian movement.

The question of case selection is a bugbear for any volume that analyses a discrete group of cases or examples. I do not make any claims of scientific precision. If you were to ask five lawyers for their list of ten forgotten cases, you would probably have five very different-looking lists, with some overlap. Put simply, while the cases considered in this book involved important legal issues, their significance transcended the legal questions that arose for the courts' consideration. This may be because of the political consequences of a case, the social impact that the case had (or didn't have), or the way in which the case was depicted in the press. Time plays an interesting role in separating landmark cases from forgotten ones. The lapse of time results in some cases fading into oblivion, and reinforces and strengthens the significance of others. In other words, 'forgotten' does not necessarily mean 'old'. While two cases considered in this book are from the early 1950s, five others are from the 1990s.

To those readers that are lawyers or legal scholars trained in India, I have written this book in the hope that it also has something to offer you. Many of you will know something about each of the cases considered in this book. Indeed, some of you may know quite a bit about the legal questions at issue in the ten 'forgotten' cases. This book is not intended to be merely a 'plain language' translation of selected Supreme Court and high court cases. Rather, it aims to bring the narratives of each of those cases to life through news reports and other contemporaneous sources. You probably know in whose favour the court made its decision, but you may not know that a police band had ironically been commissioned to play the tunes of victory to celebrate the expected *failure* of the state prosecution (see the chapter on the R.D. Bajaj case). The chapters in this book either seek to tell a story that is untold, or narrate a known story from a different perspective.

This book deviates from the dominant narrative about the role of courts in two important ways. First, it avoids the well-trodden path of nostalgia